

INITIAL LANGUAGE EVALUATION REPORT

SERRIE Axel

Candidate Name	SERRIE Axel
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Department	Informatique
Job Title	Lead Tech Back-End
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1. Executive Summary

Axel SERRIE is a motivated, communicative user of English operating at a consolidated **B1+ (2.5)** level overall, as determined by a combined written test and oral assessment conducted by Linguaid France in June 2026. His English is functional and intelligible across all five skill areas, and he demonstrates genuine communicative intent — he is willing to attempt expression even when uncertain of the language required, and he is not afraid to ask for clarification. These are strong foundations for accelerated progress.

The assessment reveals a candidate whose **receptive skills** (reading and listening) are slightly ahead of his **productive skills** (writing and speaking), a pattern consistent with a learner who has significant passive exposure to English — through his professional environment at Station F/HEC and his weekend sports coaching activities — but who has had limited structured opportunity to develop grammatical accuracy, lexical precision, and spoken confidence in formal contexts.

The most consistent gaps identified across both written and oral assessment are: **tense management and consistency, article and preposition use, uncountable noun handling**, and — critically — **spoken confidence and composure under communicative pressure**. This last point is not a linguistic weakness in itself, but it significantly limits Axel's ability to deploy the English he already possesses, particularly in high-stakes professional situations such as meetings with senior stakeholders or international pitches.

> Final Overall CEFR Level: B1+ (2.5)

| 1.1 Skills Overview

Skill Area	CEFR Level	Score
Grammar	B1+	2.5
Writing	B1	2.0
Reading / Vocabulary	B1+	2.5
Listening	B1+	2.5
Speaking	B1	2.0
Overall Final Level	B1+	2.5

2. Skill-by-Skill Assessment

| 2.1 Reading and Vocabulary — B1+ (2.5)

Strengths

- Axel demonstrates solid general reading comprehension, achieving a score of **23/30 (77%)** on the MCQ written test, which comfortably places him at B1+.
- He deploys a functional professional vocabulary spanning two distinct domains — **technology and competitive sport** — without significant breakdown in either.
- His use of discourse connectors such as *"in order to"*, *"that's why"*, and *"probably"* demonstrates awareness of cohesive devices and causal relationships in written English.
- His familiarity with English-language professional content (web applications, startup ecosystems, delivery frameworks) is evident and reflects genuine workplace immersion.

Development Areas

- **Lexical precision:** Axel occasionally uses Gallicisms — for example, *"incubees"* (from French *incubés*) where *"startup residents"* or *"incubatees"* would be the English equivalent. This suggests that some vocabulary has been acquired through French-to-English mapping rather than authentic English exposure.
- **Collocational range:** Phrases such as *"bring them up to World Championships"* and *"cheerleading industry"* indicate limited familiarity with native-level collocational patterns. At B2, candidates are expected to select natural word combinations more reliably.
- **Register awareness:** Axel mixes informal expressions (*"that's ok"*) with more formal professional vocabulary within the same passage, suggesting that his awareness of stylistic register in English is still developing.

- **Synonymy and lexical variety:** Axel tends to repeat the same words (e.g., "*grow*") across different contexts rather than paraphrasing or varying his lexical choices — a feature more characteristic of B1 than B2.

| 2.2 Writing — B1 (2.0)

Strengths

- Axel's written responses are **communicatively effective**: his meaning is clear throughout and he does not lose the reader at any point — a core B1+ competency.
- He consistently organises his writing with a logical narrative structure, particularly visible in Q40, where he moves fluently from childhood geography to university to present life in Paris using appropriate past and present tenses.
- He demonstrates awareness of purposive and causal connectors ("*in order to*", "*that's why*") that indicate a developing capacity for discourse-level organisation beyond simple sentence listing.
- His professional register is generally appropriate and reflects genuine engagement with English in his working environment.

Development Areas

- **Subject-verb agreement:** The third-person singular *-s* is inconsistently applied — e.g., "*This app create opportunity*" → "*This app creates opportunities*". This is a high-frequency error that affects the overall impression of grammatical control.
- **Article usage:** Articles are frequently omitted or misapplied, particularly with abstract and uncountable nouns — e.g., "*I'm lead tech developer*" → "*I'm the lead tech developer*"; "*The life were quiet*" → "*Life was quiet*".
- **Preposition accuracy:** Spatial prepositions are applied inconsistently and appear influenced by French patterns — e.g., "*I lived at Loiret*" → "*I lived in Loiret*"; "*I went to high school at Montargis*" → "*in Montargis*".
- **Uncountable nouns:** *Time*, *life*, and *opportunity* are incorrectly treated as countable — e.g., "*It will take times*" → "*It will take time*". This is a well-documented area of L1 (French) interference.
- **Extended production:** Axel's Q41 response is notably brief. At B2, candidates are expected to develop ideas, justify positions, and acknowledge nuance in extended written responses. This capacity requires deliberate practice.
- **Complex structures absent:** No passive constructions, conditionals, or reported speech appear in the writing samples. Their absence — rather than incorrect use — is consistent with B1+ and indicates that these structures are not yet reliably part of Axel's active grammatical repertoire.

| 2.3 Grammar — B1+ (2.5)

Strengths

- Axel has a solid foundation in basic **present simple and present continuous usage**, applying them appropriately for habitual actions, professional facts, and ongoing situations.
- He uses **modal and future structures** with reasonable confidence — *"I will probably come back"*, *"I would like to continue"* — showing awareness of hedging and politeness conventions.
- His use of **subordinate clauses and clause-linking** (*"in order to help them to grow"*, *"that's why I live in Paris now"*) demonstrates a developing syntactic capacity beyond simple coordination.
- His **chronological sequencing** in narrative writing is grammatically clean and well-managed.

Development Areas

- **Tense consistency:** This is the most prominent recurring gap, flagged in both written and oral assessment. Tenses are described as "quite confused" in the oral observation, and written samples confirm instability in tense selection and agreement — particularly the erroneous *"The life were quiet"* (uncountable noun + plural verb) and inconsistent past/present transitions.
- **The full article system:** Definite, indefinite, and zero article use with abstract and uncountable nouns remains incompletely acquired and represents a priority remediation area.
- **Prepositions of place:** The *in/at/on* distinction with geographical names and locations follows French rather than English conventions and requires targeted correction.
- **Pluralisation of uncountable nouns:** Systematic over-pluralisation of nouns such as *time*, *life*, and *opportunity* is a direct L1 interference pattern that must be addressed explicitly.
- **Higher-order structures:** Passive voice, conditional sentences, and reported speech are absent from active production, limiting Axel's ability to communicate at B2 across professional genres such as pitching, reporting, and negotiating.

| 2.4 Listening — B1+ (2.5)

Strengths

- Axel demonstrates reliable receptive comprehension at B1+ level, following the oral session comfortably and responding relevantly to questions posed by the evaluator.
- He is able to process and understand spoken English in a real-time professional interaction, including spontaneous rephrasing and topic shifts — consistent with his regular exposure to English in multilingual team meetings.
- His comprehension is supported by a willingness to ask for clarification rather than guess or disengage, which is a strong communicative strategy.

Development Areas

- **Processing under pressure:** While general comprehension is solid, Axel can experience difficulty when faced with fast-paced or complex spoken input in high-stakes situations — a pattern linked to the confidence and composure gaps identified in speaking (see 2.5 below).
- **Listening for detail and nuance:** At B2, candidates are expected to follow extended discussions, identify implied meaning, and track complex argumentation. Developing active listening strategies — note-taking, paraphrasing, checking understanding — will support this progression.

| 2.5 Speaking — B1 (2.0)

Strengths

- **Interaction:** Axel engages willingly and naturally in conversational exchange. He does not shut down when he encounters a gap in his knowledge and will attempt to communicate even with imperfect language — a quality explicitly noted by the evaluator as a significant professional asset.
- **Fluency:** Rated *Good* — Axel maintains communicative flow in familiar contexts without excessive hesitation, and he demonstrates an ability to sustain short, coherent spoken turns.
- **Professional willingness:** He already uses English regularly in his workplace (weekly or twice-weekly meetings with an international colleague) and on weekends in a coaching capacity. This real-world practice is a substantial advantage.
- **Not afraid to ask questions:** A notable strength identified during the oral session. Axel seeks clarification proactively, which supports both comprehension and language acquisition.

Development Areas

- **Confidence and composure under pressure:** This is identified as the **single most significant barrier** to Axel's spoken performance at this stage. He has reported panicking when he "blanks" — particularly under observation from senior colleagues such as his CTO. This anxiety-driven disruption affects his ability to access the language he demonstrably possesses. Developing **recovery strategies** (pausing deliberately, rephrasing, buying time with functional phrases) is a training priority.
- **Tense management in spoken production:** As in writing, tense confusion is pronounced in spontaneous speech. Real-time tense selection requires both grammatical consolidation and fluency-building practice.
- **Accuracy (grammar) and Vocabulary range:** Both rated *Developing*, consistent with the written assessment findings. The same gaps — articles, prepositions, collocations, uncountable nouns — manifest in spoken production.
- **Pronunciation:** Rated *Developing*. While intelligibility is maintained, phonological features of French-accented English (liaison, syllable-timed rhythm, final consonant devoicing) may affect professional reception in high-stakes international contexts and should be addressed progressively within the training programme.
- **Strategic oral production:** At B2, candidates are expected to **structure spoken contributions** — to introduce a point, develop it, and signal a conclusion —

particularly in meeting and presentation contexts. This skill requires explicit modelling and practice.

3. Learning Objectives

The following three objectives are designed for Axel's 15-hour training programme and mapped to Bloom's Taxonomy to reflect increasing levels of cognitive and communicative complexity. Each objective targets both the linguistic gaps identified in assessment and the professional communication goals validated by the candidate.

□ Objective 1 — *Identify and Apply* (Bloom's Levels 1-3: Remember / Understand / Apply)

Target competency: Grammar accuracy — tense use and consistency, articles, prepositions, and uncountable nouns

> By the end of the programme, Axel will be able to **identify, distinguish, and consistently apply** the core grammar rules governing English tense selection (present simple, present continuous, past simple, and will-future), the article system (a / an / the / Ø), spatial prepositions (in / at / on) with place names and professional contexts, and the correct treatment of high-frequency uncountable nouns (time, life, opportunity), producing grammatically accurate spoken and written output at a B1+/B2 level with measurably fewer systematic errors across professional communication tasks.

□ Objective 2 — *Structure and Deliver* (Bloom's Levels 3-4: Apply / Analyse)

Target competency: Spoken confidence and professional oral production — meetings, pitching, and turn-taking

> By the end of the programme, Axel will be able to **prepare, structure, and deliver** a 2-3 minute professional pitch in English — presenting his role, the Rouage application, and its value to stakeholders — using appropriate discourse markers, persuasive language, and professional register; and will be able to **participate actively** in a short professional meeting in English, taking turns, expressing and justifying opinions, and deploying functional recovery strategies (deliberate pausing, rephrasing, time-buying phrases) to maintain composure and fluency when faced with gaps or unexpected questions, at a B1+/B2 level of spoken coherence.

□ Objective 3 — *Evaluate and Negotiate* (Bloom's Levels 5-6: Evaluate / Create)

Target competency: Strategic professional communication — negotiation, compromise, and adaptive reasoning in English

> By the end of the programme, Axel will be able to **conduct a simulated professional negotiation** in English — making, justifying, and adapting proposals in real time, acknowledging counterarguments, and seeking compromise — using conditional structures (*If we were to... / If that's acceptable to you...*), concession language (*That said... / I understand your position, however...*), and professional register appropriate to real workplace interactions at B2, demonstrating both the linguistic competence and the communicative confidence to defend his interests clearly in an international professional context.

4. Training Plan

4.1 Programme Overview

Parameter	Detail
Current Level	B1+ (2.5)
Target Level	B1+ (2.5) consolidated → B2 readiness
Total Programme Hours	15 hours
Coached Session Hours	10 hours
Autonomous / Homework Hours	5 hours
Delivery Format	Video call (visio)
Preferred Scheduling	Monday–Friday, ideally 12:00–14:00
Confirmed Availability	Mon–Fri: mornings and 12:00–14:00

4.2 Priority Content Areas

The following content areas are listed in order of instructional priority, informed by both the assessment findings and Axel's validated professional goals:

Priority 1 — Grammar: Tenses and Core Accuracy

- Present simple vs. present continuous — form and function
- Past simple — regular and irregular verbs; past narrative construction
- Will-future and *would like to* for professional plans and intentions
- The article system: a / an / the / Ø with countable, uncountable, and abstract nouns
- Spatial prepositions: in / at / on with place names, buildings, and professional contexts
- Uncountable nouns in professional English: *time, information, advice, feedback, progress*

Priority 2 — Spoken Confidence and Professional Fluency

- Recovery strategies for moments of communicative breakdown: deliberate pause, rephrasing, clarification requests (*"What I mean is..."*, *"Could you give me a moment?"*, *"Let me put that another way..."*)
- Turn-taking in meetings: entering a discussion, holding the floor, and handing back (*"I'd like to add..."*, *"Building on that..."*, *"What do you think?"*)
- Expressing and justifying opinions professionally (*"In my view..."*, *"I think this works because..."*, *"The reason I suggest this is..."*)
- Pronunciation focus: word stress in professional vocabulary, natural pausing, and rhythm in spoken English

Priority 3 — Pitch and Presentation Skills

- Structuring a professional pitch: opening hook, problem statement, solution, value proposition, call to action
- Signposting language: *"I'd like to start by..."*, *"Moving on to..."*, *"To summarise..."*
- Persuasive and evaluative language appropriate to pitching a tech product
- Practice scenario: Pitching Rouage to a non-French-speaking international stakeholder

Priority 4 — Negotiation and Strategic Communication

- Making and responding to proposals: *"We could consider..."*, *"What if we were to..."*, *"That might work if..."*
- Conditionals in negotiation: second conditional for hypothetical proposals; first conditional for realistic offers
- Concession and compromise language: *"I understand your concern, however..."*, *"That's a fair point — that said..."*
- Simulation: a professional negotiation scenario relevant to Axel's working context (e.g., project scope, resource allocation, timeline discussion)

Autonomous Practice (5 hours)

- Weekly vocabulary and grammar consolidation exercises targeting identified gaps (articles, tenses, uncountable nouns)
- Short written reflection tasks (3–5 sentences) following each coached session to reinforce grammar in context

- Listening practice: short authentic professional audio content (TED-style talks, tech podcast excerpts) with comprehension and vocabulary tasks
- Spoken self-recording exercises: Axel records a 1-minute update on his work or coaching activities between sessions for evaluator feedback

| 4.3 Scheduling Notes

- **Preferred format:** Video call (visio) — confirmed
- **Ideal session time:** 12:00–14:00, Monday to Friday
- Axel is available across all weekday morning slots as well, offering flexibility for session scheduling
- Given the 10 coached hours, a rhythm of **one to two sessions per week** of 60 minutes is recommended to allow sufficient processing and consolidation time between sessions

5. Evaluator Narrative Summary

Axel SERRIE presents as a genuinely engaged and communicatively motivated learner whose English level is well-suited to his current professional environment, while also presenting identifiable and actionable gaps that explain the specific difficulties he has reported. His situation is a familiar one: a technically proficient professional operating daily in a multilingual context, who has acquired a functional level of English largely through exposure and necessity, but who has not had the opportunity to develop the grammatical accuracy, lexical range, or spoken composure that a more structured learning pathway would have provided.

What stands out most clearly in both the written and oral assessments — and is confirmed by the evaluator's direct observations — is the gap between what Axel *knows* and what he can *produce under pressure*. His receptive skills (reading and listening, both at B1+) are ahead of his productive skills (writing and speaking, both at B1), and within speaking, his willingness to communicate is significantly ahead of his confidence in doing so formally. He has described moments of panic when he blanks — most acutely when delivering his first English-language presentation in front of his CTO — and has identified this loss of composure as his primary obstacle. This is not an uncommon pattern for speakers at his level, and it is a highly tractable one: with targeted recovery strategy training, structured presentation practice, and the gradual accumulation of successful spoken experiences in a safe environment, confidence of this kind typically develops quickly and durably.

Grammatically, the priority is clear and consistent across all assessment evidence: **tense management is the most urgent area for development**, followed closely by the article system and preposition use. These gaps are systematic rather than random, and they are largely attributable to well-documented patterns of French L1 interference —

which means they are predictable, and they respond well to explicit instruction combined with contextualised practice. Axel's professional context — working in English with an international colleague at least twice a week, and coaching in English at weekends — provides an unusually rich real-world practice environment that, combined with structured coaching, should support meaningful progress within the 15-hour programme.

Axel's learner profile is encouraging. He is motivated by genuine professional need, he is not afraid to take communicative risks in class, and he brings domain-specific vocabulary and personal investment to his learning — as a sports coach, he is already accustomed to iterative feedback, deliberate practice, and the psychology of performance under pressure